
J.D. Vance Has Found a Remarkable New Way to Seem Like an Entitled Doofus

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Wasn't it just days ago that [news outlets reported](#) that Vice President J.D. Vance had the military raise an Ohio river's water level to make conditions more optimal for his 41st-birthday kayaking trip? So how is it that he's already moved on to wreaking havoc on an entirely different locale for a whole separate getaway, this time to England's Cotswolds, where, a few days ago, his security team [allegedly dispatched](#) the police en masse in advance of his arrival? We are 12 days into August, and the Vance travel monster has managed to upend life on two separate continents.

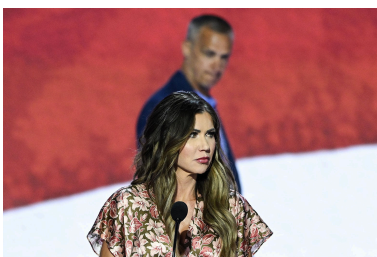
According to a dispatch from U.K.'s Observer, this was the scene:

"We have had the police knocking on every door," said a dog walker and resident of Dean, as a helicopter buzzed overhead. "They wanted the names of everybody living there and details of their social media. I know several people refused. We asked them if they were protecting us, or Vance. At least they were honest and said it is for him and that it will all be passed on to the American security people."

The locals apparently found the authorities demanding to know if they've [posted photos of Vance in the style of a Furby](#) to be "unsettling." No kidding. (Kamala Harris reportedly visited the area recently as well, but the most noteworthy thing about her stay was that she was spotted at a famous pub.)

A pattern is beginning to emerge here. In his travels this year, the vice president has been known to have places like the Colosseum, as well as the Taj Mahal and Disneyland, closed off to the public while he and his family enjoy a private visit—behavior that may be typical for a foreign leader of his notoriety but will do little to help his officious public image. Nor will raising the water level of a river, something I'm pretty sure I didn't even know was possible to do until I read about his ordering the Army Corps of Engineers to work their magic on the Little Miami River. Demands like this make him sound like some kind of mad king, no matter what excuses his camp makes about safety concerns. (And, hey, the New York Times noted, [Al Gore did this once too!](#))

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Anyway, does Vance *really* go on all that many vacations? The [full rundown of Vance's other destinations](#) this year—remember, he's been in office only since January—includes Italy, India, Vermont, [Greenland](#), Disneyland, and Nantucket. Many of those were “official trips,” which politicians from both parties take frequently, reasonably or not. And it's not unusual for anyone to spend time with their families in August. But as with many things in his life, Vance does seem to have a unique knack for looking like a complete jerk when it's his turn. The former Ohio senator is already known for many dubious things—he is the guy who mocked “childless cat ladies,” the guy [who's utterly convinced](#) that he has a great sense of humor, and the guy who always looks [as if he has eyeliner on](#), to name a few—but being a guy who has main-character energy in foreign resort towns is some kind of humiliating new low. It's almost as bad as being a president [who's always golfing](#).

On his trip to the Cotswolds, Vance is reportedly staying in an \$11,000-a-week house, though the cost of the trip to taxpayers for those social-media close reads will surely dwarf that by some multiple. Despite all the headlines, I don't think we have any real hope of making Vance feel shame or humility. But on a purely surface level, next time he books a trip—[the Daily Beast says](#) he has his heart set on getting to Hawaii one of these days—maybe he'll at least think about how this all looks to everybody else.

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